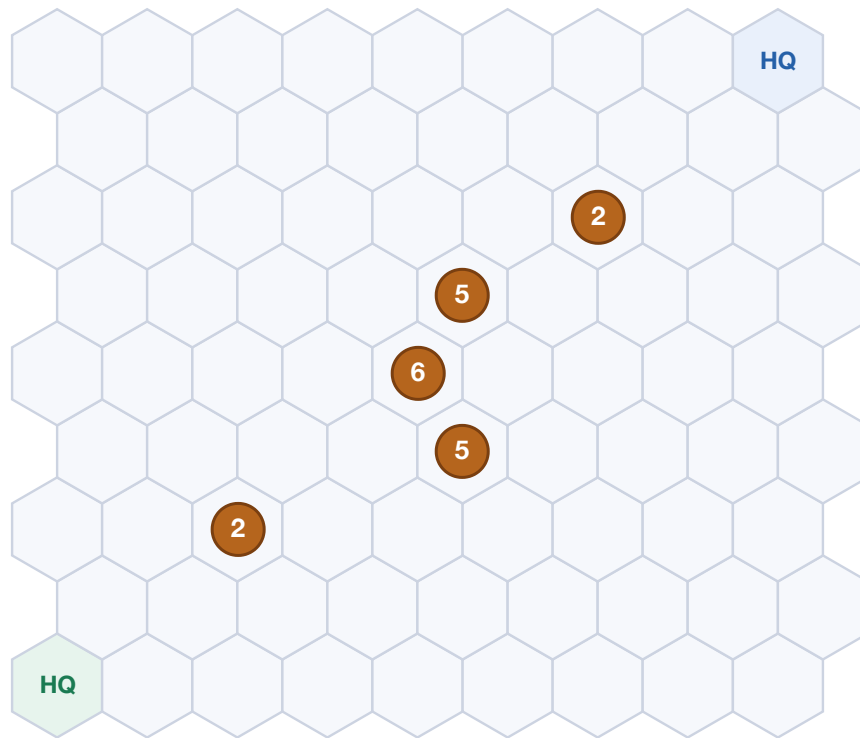


HYPERSCALE

Build an AI-datacenter empire — 1 player vs. the computer

Ages 12+ · ~10–15 minutes · hex board



Player's Guide · 9×9 hex board · two HQs, five power stations

The Idea

You and the computer each run a datacenter company from a corner **HQ**. Over **24 days** you claim ground, wire datacenters to shared **power stations**, staff and equip them, and sell their output as **AI tokens**. Power is scarce and fixed to the map, so most of the game is a fight over the same few stations. **Whoever has produced the most AI tokens after day 24 wins.**

The Board

A 9x9 hex grid. Your **HQ** sits in one corner, the **AI's HQ** in the opposite one. Five **power stations** are fixed on the map, each with a capacity (the number on it = how many servers it can power):

Stations	Where	Capacity
Central corridor (3 stations)	middle of the board	5 + 6 + 5 = 16 power
Two home stations	one near each HQ	2 each

There are only **20 power** on the whole board and no way to make more. The big central corridor is the prize — sitting in your corner only ever powers ~2 servers, so the game is decided in the middle.

A Day = 3 Actions

You and the AI alternate days. On your day you take up to **3 actions**, then end the day. At the start of every day your powered servers produce tokens and pay their running costs automatically. Each action is one of:

Build a piece
Road, power line, or datacenter on an empty hex.

Add a server
Equip one of your datacenters with a server (buys parts from the market).

Prestock a part
Buy GPU / HBM / CPU from the market to hold for later.

Sabotage
Demolish an adjacent enemy road or power line (once per day). See below.

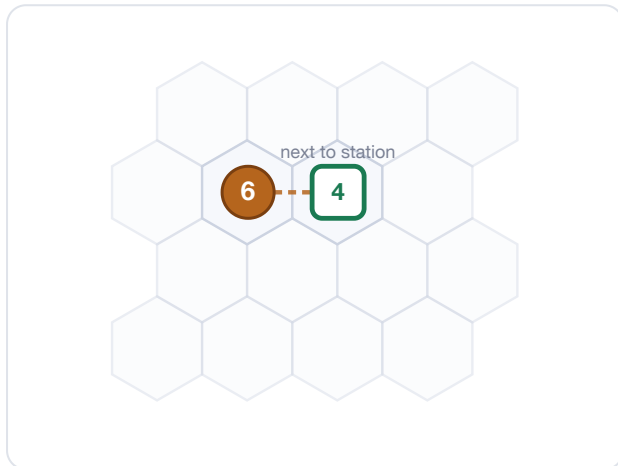
What You Build

Piece	Cost	What it does
Road	\$1	Connects a datacenter back to your HQ so it can be staffed . Chains hex to hex.
Power line	\$2	Extends power from a station to a datacenter that isn't next to one. Chains hex to hex.
Datacenter	\$4	Holds up to 4 servers . Earns only when it's both road-connected and powered.

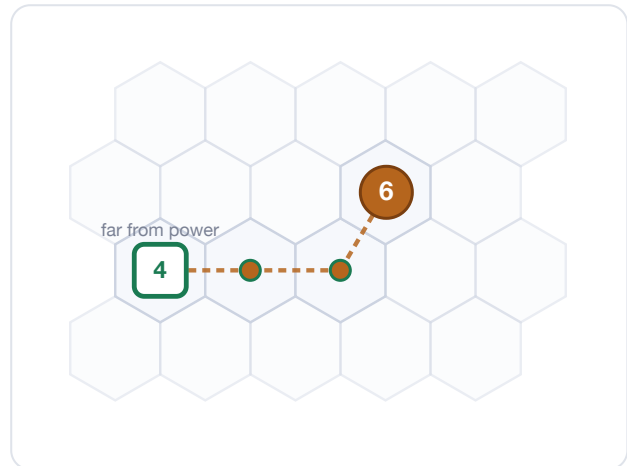
Every piece **occupies its hex** and blocks the opponent from routing through it — walling off the enemy's path is a real tactic.

Powering a Datacenter

A datacenter draws power if it is **next to a station**, or if a chain of your **power-line pieces** connects it to one. It draws from every station its network touches (multi-source), so wiring to several stations makes it resilient if the opponent hogs one.



Built **next to a station** — powered for free (dashed line = the power link).



Built far away — a chain of **power-line pieces** (\$2 each) carries power out to it.

A datacenter needs **both** a road to HQ *and* power to earn. A road with no power = *unpowered*; power with no road = *no staff*. Neither produces a thing.

Servers & the Market

Output comes from **servers**. One server = **2 GPU + 1 HBM + 1 CPU**, bought from a single shared, finite market. Prices **rise as the reserve depletes**, so the parts get more expensive the more everyone buys — and GPU (the scarcest) can run out entirely. A datacenter holds at most **4 servers**, so you can't win by scaling one giant site; you must spread across the contested stations.

You can **prestock** parts to hold for later. Use it to *hedge* a coming price rise or to *deny* the scarce GPU to the AI — but parts you buy and never install are wasted money. Buying just-in-time is usually cheaper.

Running Costs: Power & Staff

Each powered server earns revenue every day but also costs money to run:

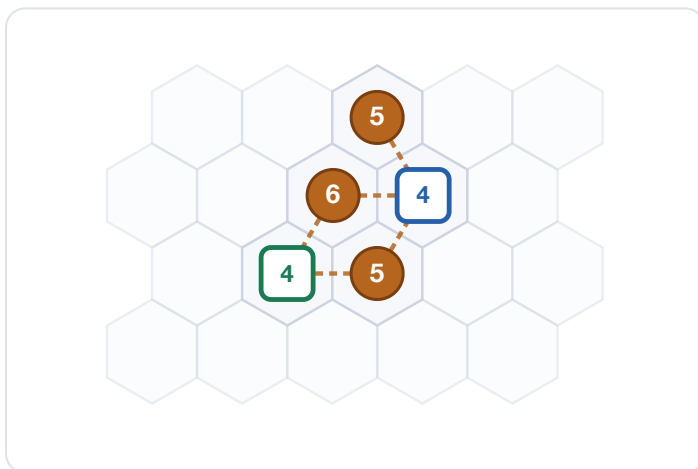
- **Power** — a flat cost per powered server.
- **Staffing (manning)** — grows with the **road distance** from the datacenter back to your HQ. A site far from home costs more to keep running.



A datacenter 3 road-hops from HQ. The further the road path, the higher its daily staffing cost — and blocking the enemy into detours raises *theirs*.

The Fight for the Centre

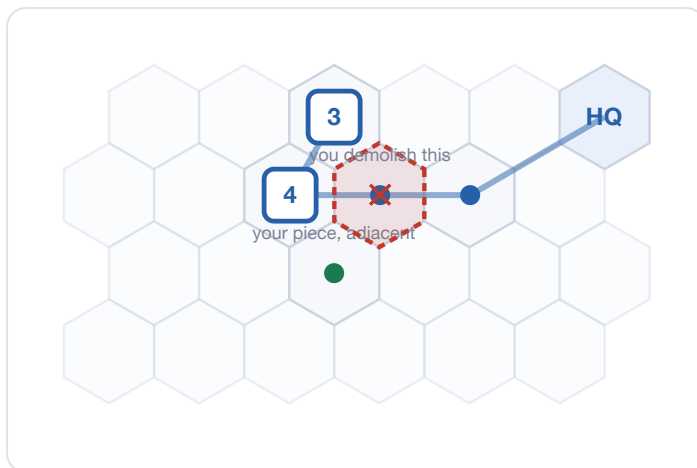
Both players draw from the same central stations, so their capacity is **shared and contested**. When servers compete for a station, the bigger datacenters get powered first; the rest sit **dark** (built, but producing nothing). Installing more servers than you can actually power is wasted money.



Both of you wire into the central corridor. The 16 central power is split between you — grab your share early.

Sabotage

Once per day you may spend an action and **\$3** to **demolish an enemy road or power-line piece** — but only one that sits **next to a piece of yours**, so you have to push into their space first. You can't destroy a datacenter itself; you cut the **connective tissue** that keeps it running.



Their two datacenters hang off one road. Get a piece next to the **choke point** and demolish it — both sites lose their link to HQ and go dark until rebuilt.

Cutting a **choke point** — a single road or power line that several datacenters depend on — hits hardest. Defend by building **redundant routes** so no one piece is critical, and rebuild a cut link promptly (it's cheap). It's a tempo weapon, not a knockout: limited to once a day, and the victim repairs for a dollar or two.

Winning

Score is **cumulative**: every day, each powered server adds one AI token to your total. After **day 24**, the higher total wins. Because it's cumulative, **timing is everything** — a server switched on early earns for ~20 days; the same server built on the last day earns once.

Strategy Tips

- **Get online fast and stay full.** Fill a datacenter to 4 powered servers before starting the next one — early tokens compound, late ones barely count.
- **Contest the centre.** Turtling on your 2-power home station caps you at a trivial score. Race a road to the central corridor and claim your share of the 16.
- **Don't build dark servers.** If a station is full, extra servers there produce nothing. Wire to another open station instead.
- **Buy parts just-in-time.** Prices climb as the market drains and leftover stock is dead money. Prestock only to hedge a spike or to starve the AI of GPU.
- **Mind the manning bill.** A far-flung site earns the same tokens but costs more to staff — and you can raise the enemy's costs by walling their roads into detours.
- **Wire to more than one station** so a contested pool going full doesn't strand your servers.
- **Sabotage choke points, not leaves.** Cutting the one road that carries a cluster of the enemy's sites is worth an action; snipping a dead-end road that carries nothing is not. And keep your own critical links backed up with a spare route.

Quick Reference

Build	Cost	Build	Cost
Road	\$1	Datacenter	\$4 (max 4 servers)
Power line	\$2	Server	2 GPU + 1 HBM + 1 CPU (market price)

Rule	Value
Length of game	24 days, 3 actions per day
Total power on the board	20 (central 16, two homes 2 each)
A datacenter earns when	road-connected to HQ and powered (adjacent or wired to a station)
Server output	1 AI token per powered server per day (score = cumulative)
Daily cost per server	power (flat) + staffing (grows with road distance from HQ)
Market	shared & finite; prices rise as it depletes; GPU is scarcest
Sabotage	\$3, once/day; demolish an enemy road/power line next to your piece; cuts their downstream sites offline
Win	most cumulative AI tokens after day 24